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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN A LA KING, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal Specification was developed by the US Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chicken a la king thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative

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bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specifications For

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900	-	Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades

(Application for copies should be addressed to Director, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas
U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

National Academy of Science

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, Washington, DC 20418.)

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

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3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen ready-to-cook fowl (mature female chicken) which has been processed in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The chickens shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Grading Branch Certificate to certify class and condition of the product and either the initial chilling date or initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.1 Chilled chicken. Chicken received in the chilled state shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days following initial chilling to further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.2 Frozen chicken. Raw uncooked chickens received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 75 days following initial freezing to further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.3 Chicken, diced, frozen, precooked. Precooked, frozen chicken shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch. In this case, conditions in 3.2.1, 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.1.2 shall apply prior to cooking. The cooked dices shall be screened after dicing to ensure compliance with end item requirements (see 3.6). The cooked dice shall be frozen to 0°F within 72 hours after cooking, packaged and sealed in water impermeable material having an oxygen permeability of not more than 10cc of oxygen per square meter per 24 hours per mil thickness at 73°F and O percent relative humidity. The packaged frozen chicken dices shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 30 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4).

3.2.2 Broth, chicken. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free, with percent solids sufficient to comply with the solids requirements in the sauce formulation. The chicken broth shall have a characteristic mild chicken broth

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odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by the Food and Drug Administration. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with the USDA regulations and when frozen shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation.

3.2.3 Cheese, cream, fresh. The fresh cream cheese shall conform to the Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, Standard of Identity for Cream Cheese. The cream cheese shall have a creamy flavor and shall be moderately salted. It may have a very slight acid flavor and aroma or slight cooked flavor. The body and texture shall be smooth, creamy and uniformly white in color. The cream cheese shall not be coarse, crumbly, gummy, grainy, sticky, nor have any free whey present.

3.2.4 Chicken fat. Frozen chicken fat shall be purchased. The chicken fat shall have a characteristic clear yellow color, chicken-fat odor and flavor. The chicken fat may contain antioxidants approved by the Food Safety Inspection Service (FSIS) of USDA. The chicken fat shall have a peroxide value not to exceed 6 meq./kg., a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation.

3.2.5 Mushrooms, canned, stems and pieces. The canned mushrooms shall be U.S. Grade B or better, Stems and Pieces of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be drained prior to use in the sauce formulation.

3.2.6 Starch, modified, high opacity. The starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. It shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The cooked starch slurry shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.7 Peas, green, frozen. Frozen peas shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas, and shall be the latest season's crop.

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3.2.8 Shortening, vegetable, powdered. The powdered vegetable shortening shall consist of components which, when combined, will serve as a product whitening agent. The powdered shortening, when used as an ingredient in this product, shall withstand the conditions of thermoprocessing specified in this specification without browning. A typical analysis of this powdered shortening follows:

Fat	- 75.00 percent ± 1.50 percent
Protein	- 5.50 percent ± 0.50 percent
Carbohydrates	- 15.00 percent ± 1.00 percent
Moisture	- 2.00 percent maximum

3.2.9 Pimientos, canned. Pimientos shall be of any style and shall be U.S. Grade C or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Pimientos.

3.2.10 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. The dehydrated chopped onion shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.11 Monosodium glutamate. Monosodium glutamate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.13 Celery, sliced, dehydrated. The dehydrated sliced celery shall be obtained from clean, sound Pascal type celery. The celery shall be approximately 3/8 inch crosscut stalk slices, with no leaf cuts. The slices shall be free flowing and have bright uniform color. The dehydrated celery shall have a moisture content not in excess of 4.5 percent and a sulfur dioxide content of 750 ± 250 ppm.

3.2.14 Peppers, green, sweet, freeze-dried. The peppers shall be 1/4 inch dices of sweet Bell peppers which have been sulfited and dehydrated by freeze-drying or partially air-dryed followed by freeze-drying. The dices shall be free of seeds, seed cells and diseased or rotted areas. The pepper dices shall have a fresh, clean typical sweet green pepper flavor and odor and a green with minimal brownish color. The moisture content shall be not greater than 4 percent and the sulfite level shall be in the range of 500 to 1500 ppm as sulfur dioxide.

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3.2.15 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.16 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground white pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.17 Bay leaves, ground. Ground bay leaves shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. The bay leaves shall possess a pleasant aromatic odor and pungent, mildly bitter flavor with a pale green to yellow green color. A minimum of 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground bay leaves.

3.2.18 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, rehydration and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.19 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

3.3.1 Chicken preparation. The chicken shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless and trimmed of all tendons, cartilage, large blood vessels, blood clots, discolorations, bruises, blemishes, feathers and hair. The chicken shall be cooked by water cooking, roasting or steaming. The broth from cooking the chicken may be used in the sauce preparation in the amount and in compliance with the solids content as required. The deboned chicken shall consist by weight of not less than 50 percent but not more than 60 percent white meat and not less than 40 percent but not more than 50 percent dark meat.

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b. The cooked chicken shall be cooled to 40°F or below immediately following the cooking process and held at that temperature or lower for not longer than 48 hours prior to filling.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/4 by 3/4 by 3/4 inch.

d. The cooked dices shall be screened after dicing to ensure compliance with end item requirements (see 3.6.).

e. Precooked, frozen chicken dices may be used provided they comply with the processing requirements of 3.3.1 a,b,c,d and the material requirements, of 3.2.1.3. In addition, precooked frozen diced chicken shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Grading Branch Certificate certifying compliance to all the requirements of this paragraph. If frozen precooked chicken is used, chicken broth will have to be purchased.

3.3.2 Preparation of onions, celery and green peppers. The dehydrated onions, celery and green peppers shall be fully rehydrated in an excess of water, then thoroughly drained before incorporating into the sauce.

3.3.3 Sauce preparation. The sauce shall be formulated as follows:

Ingredient	Percent
Chicken broth (3.0 to 3.5 percent solids) 1/	67.61
Cream cheese	4.50
Chicken fat	4.33
Mushrooms stems and pieces, canned, drained	3.67
Starch, modified, high opacity	6.00
Peas, green, frozen	3.52
Powdered vegetable shortening	2.25
Pimiento, diced, canned	1.78
Onion, chopped, dehydrated	1.77
Brine from canned mushrooms	1.70
Monosodium glutamate	0.78
Salt	0.75
Celery, sliced, dehydrated	0.55
Green pepper, diced, dehydrated	0.32
Lecithin	0.32
Pepper, white, ground	0.10
Bay leaves, ground	0.05

1/ Chicken broth with different soluble solids content shall be adjusted to the required solids content.

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a. A slurry shall be made using part of the chicken broth, the starch and the powdered vegetable shortening.

b. The remainder of the chicken broth, mushroom brine, chicken fat and lecithin shall be heated to a boil in a steam-jacketed kettle with continuous and vigorous agitation to attain the maximum emulsification of the fat into the broth.

c. The cream cheese shall be added and the emulsion stirred until the cheese is completely melted.

d. The emulsion shall be cooled to 180°F or lower and the remaining ingredients added, except the slurry. The emulsion shall be stirred to assure that the salt is dissolved, the dehydrated vegetables are rehydrated and the spices uniformly dispersed.

e. The slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to 180° to 190°F and held in this temperature range for 5 minutes.

f. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

g. The sauce shall be filled into the tray pack cans within 4 hours after cooking. The temperature of the prepared sauce shall be held at 150°-180°F until filling into the tray cans.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The diced chicken and sauce shall be filled in the following proportions:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Chicken, diced, cooked	45.00
Sauce	55.00

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b. The diced chicken and sauce may be filled separately or may be combined prior to filling. When combined prior to filling, the temperature of the chicken dices shall be in the range of 28° to 40°F at the time of combining. The mixture shall be heated to 150° to 180° and filled in that temperature range.

c. Each can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.

d. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within one hour after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F or below in accordance with a scheduled process until a sterilization value (Fo) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not restricted to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not restricted to rancid, burnt, stale, sour or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. There shall be no cartilage or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

f. There shall be no pieces of skin, blood clot, bruises, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

g. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

h. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 40 ounces of drained chicken dices.

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j. No individual can shall contain less than 16 ounces of drained vegetable pieces.

k. Texture of chicken dices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

l. Texture of vegetables shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous or tough.

m. Chicken dices shall be at least 75 percent distinct dices.

n. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

o. The average fat content shall be not greater than 7.0 percent.

p. The fat content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 9.0 percent.

q. The salt content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 1.2 percent nor less than 0.5 percent.

r. The product shall have the appearance of a uniform distribution of chicken dices and sauce.

s. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened, scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

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4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such supplier-furnished valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

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4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection. 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0-3200	8		0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201-35000	13		0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be acceptable.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Product inspection 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
152	Presence of cartilage or sections of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
153	Presence of skin, blood clots, bruise or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
154	Drained weight of recognizable chicken dices in a can is less than 40.0 ounces. 3/
155	Drained weight of recognizable vegetable pieces in a can is less than 16.0 ounces. 3/
156	Texture of chicken dices dry, rubbery or mushy. 4/
157	Less than 75 percent distinct chicken dices.
158	Sauce consistency lumpy or is excessively thick or thin.
159	Texture of vegetables mushy, hard, fibrous or tough.
160	Product shows evidence of excess heating (materially darkened or scorched).
161	Chicken dices and sauce not uniformly distributed.

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1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.) foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee or a Poultry Grading Branch representative.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ Drained weight shall be determined as follows:

a. Open each can and pour the entire contents into a suitable container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 200°F water shall be added to the container. The product shall be stirred gently to assure the sauce is fully diluted but not unduly break up the chicken or vegetables.

b. The diluted sauce shall be decanted through a U.S. Standard No. 7 sieve. Any vegetables or chicken on the sieve shall be returned to the mixing container.

c. Transfer the contents of the sieve to a bucket of salt water (24 ounces of table salt dissolved in 14.5 pounds of cool tap water).

d. Stir gently for one to two seconds to help separate the vegetable pieces.

e. Quickly remove the floating vegetables with a fine mesh wire strainer. Quick removal of the floating vegetables is essential to prevent their pick up of salt and subsequently sinking into the chicken.

f. Pour the salt solution, the chicken and the remaining vegetables onto a U.S. Standard No. 7 sieve. Tip the sieve at an approximate 45 degree angle to facilitate drainage. Allow to drain for two minutes. Manually remove the vegetables. Weigh the combined vegetables.

g. Determine the drained weight of the chicken by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

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4/ Examination for chicken dice texture conformance shall be made of representative chicken dices immediately following the test for drained weight (see footnote 3/)

4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 7.0 percent.

b. The fat content in any individual tray pack is greater than 9.0 percent.

c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is greater than 1.2 percent or less than 0.5 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserved sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

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4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: (1) National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above the top edge of box; (4) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (5) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated with material suitable for the product. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

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5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed, in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The can shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed an closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimension of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

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TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Caution: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed cans in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Twelve (12) servings (1 cup per serving)

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

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6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.18/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A499

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
PP-C-002192A(Army-GL)	Chicken A La King, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 20 Nov 84

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